

Chapter 55-3

//

After telling Zhao Xuning about this matter, Liang Shi felt an indescribable sense of relief.

It was that feeling of not having to live in this world using another person's identity.

Someone knew that I am me.

This was a state that was very difficult to express in words, making Liang Shi so happy that she wanted to invite Zhao Xuning to dinner. But Zhao Xuning said she still had to work the night shift and seriously declined her invitation.

She also told her not to try to get closer.

"..."

However, Zhao Xuning did ask her one question: "Regarding your situation, how much does Xu Qingzhu know?"

"Seventy percent," Liang Shi answered. "We also share a lot of information between us."

Zhao Xuning paused for a moment. "Aren't you afraid I'll tell others about this? When you reveal a secret, no matter how reliable the person is, there's always a risk of it being leaked."

"Don't use those you suspect; don't suspect those you use." Liang Shi threw her own words back at her.

Zhao Xuning frowned slightly, then said, "Don't be too confident about everything."

Liang Shi knew she was giving her guidance and replied warmly, "The moment a secret is spoken, it's no longer a secret. By telling you this, I'm showing that I'm prepared for all the worst outcomes, including you sending me to a research institute."

"Have you thought of countermeasures too?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Liang Shi smiled. "At worst, I'll be treated as mentally ill."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Liang Shi's voice was gentle, but her expression was firm, making people involuntarily follow her emotions. "What you gain and what you give are always proportional. When I choose to hand you the knife handle, I must consider the possibility that you might stab me in a vital spot. I'm willing to pay the price for my poor judgment of character."

Liang Shi wanted to gain Zhao Xuning's trust, so she had to pay a price.

And this payment might push her into a desperate situation.

Rather than saying she trusted Zhao Xuning, it was more accurate to say she trusted her own judgment and intuition.

But she couldn't be so confident as to think she would never make a mistake.

So she was prepared to be backstabbed.

Even though that possibility was minimal.

But this was the price she was willing to pay for her choice.

Nothing could have only benefits without drawbacks.

If she could bear the good, she could naturally bear the bad as well.

This was why she was going all in.

She could handle it.

Her tone was calm, but the feeling it conveyed was shocking.

Zhao Xuning sat there frozen.

After a long while, she curled her lips. "You're quite interesting."

"You used to be an actress?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Liang Shi nodded. "Yes."

After that, Zhao Xuning didn't ask her any more questions, just casually chatted about things related to the original owner.

She said she had disliked the original owner because she had too much hostility, thinking everyone was out to harm her, like she had persecution paranoia. But such a person would also hurt others, participating in some bullying incidents, using strength to oppress the weak, and having an improper private life.

Liang Shi told her about Qi Jiao's situation, and also mentioned that she wasn't the Liang family's biological daughter.

Moreover, she had already fallen out with the Liang family and would probably have to move out of the Shallow Bay villa before long.

Zhao Xuning felt a headache coming on. She pressed her temples. "You haven't been here long, but you've caused quite a lot of trouble."

Liang Shi: "...It's okay."

"So do you also know where the Liang family's biological daughter is?" Zhao Xuning asked with precision.

After thinking, Liang Shi nodded. "Sort of."

"Planning to tell the Liang family?"

"Not currently."

She wasn't an idiot. Knowing clearly that everything was disadvantageous to her, why would she still do it out of misplaced saintly compassion?

If she escaped her current predicament and the Liang family posed no harm to her, then telling them about the real heiress would be acceptable.

But obviously now wasn't the time!

She still needed to investigate many things. Based on the information she currently had, the real heiress returning wouldn't be easy to deal with either.

People skilled at manipulating public opinion and people's hearts were never simple.

With her acting skills, she could put on a show of retreating to advance—after all, her two brothers were genuinely good to her. But she couldn't convince herself to act in front of two brothers who treated people sincerely.

It was meaningless.

Liang Shi had thought through all of this very clearly, and her logic was sound when she explained it to Zhao Xuning.

Zhao Xuning only said heavily, "As long as you've thought it through."

Liang Shi: "Why are you so dejected?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

After two seconds of silence, she said gloomily, "I don't really want to know so much about your affairs."

Liang Shi was stunned and laughed silently.

When it was time to part ways, Zhao Xuning had already driven the car out a distance, then reversed back, rolled down the window, and said in an unusually cold and serious tone, "I have an apartment in Linjiang District. If you need it, I can rent it to you as a transition."

Liang Shi: "...!"

Her eyes lit up. "Thank you, Dr. Zhao!"

Zhao Xuning drove away with an expression of speechlessness.

Standing there, Liang Shi suddenly realized that Zhao Xuning was even more of a gentleman than she had imagined.